Task 5: Part A

Case Study

Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying involves the use of digital platforms, social media, messaging apps, or gaming forums to harass, threaten, or humiliate a target. Unlike physical bullying, it is persistent, can reach a massive audience instantly, and often leaves a permanent digital footprint.

How the Crime Happens?

- Impersonation**:** An attacker creates a "finsta" (fake Instagram) or "burner" account using the victim's name and photo.
- Harassment**:** The bully posts manipulated, private, or embarrassing images of the victim, often tagging their friends and family to ensure maximum visibility.
- Isolation: The victim is blocked from reporting the content effectively as the bully creates new accounts faster than they can be banned.

Who is targeted?

Teenagers and young adults are the most frequent targets, particularly those in middle or high school. However, it also extends to public figures or individuals within niche online communities who may have differing opinions or identities.

Consequences

- Mental Health: Victims frequently experience severe anxiety, depression, and social withdrawal.
- Academic Decline**:** Fear of facing peers often leads to school avoidance and dropping grades.
- Digital Stigma: In extreme cases, the false or embarrassing information can surface during future background checks for college or jobs.